

13/08/2025

Fugitive, Meritorious, Schadenfreude, Factoid, Superfluous

1. Fugitive (भगोड़ा / फरार) (*Noun / Adjective*) (*fyoo-juh-tiv*) (*Serious*)

- **Meaning (English):**

- **Noun:** A person who has escaped from a place or is in hiding, especially to avoid arrest or persecution.
- **Adjective:** Something fleeting, short-lived.

- **Meaning (Hindi):** ऐसा व्यक्ति जो किसी स्थान से भागा हुआ हो, विशेषकर गिरफ्तारी से बचने के लिए; अस्थायी या अल्पकालिक।

- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**

- Latin *fugitivus* ("fleeing") → Old French *fugitif* → Middle English *fugitif* → Modern English *fugitive*

- **Synonym + Antonym:**

- **Synonyms:** runaway, escapee, deserter
- **Antonyms:** captive, permanent, loyalist

- **Connotation:** Neutral-to-negative depending on context; can be dramatic or legalistic.

- **Pictorial Scenario:** Imagine a person running through a dark forest at night, coat flapping, sirens in the distance.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

The fugitive, having escaped from the high-security prison, managed to evade capture for nearly three months. His life on the run was filled with uncertainty, constant movement, and a relentless fear of being found. Police agencies from multiple states coordinated to track him down, employing the latest surveillance technology and witness accounts. The case became a matter of national interest, drawing attention to security lapses and prompting reforms in correctional facilities. Eventually, he was apprehended at a remote farmhouse, bringing an end to a dramatic manhunt that had captivated the public's attention and tested the limits of law enforcement.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  **Correct:** *The fugitive was caught at the border.* (भगोड़े को सीमा पर पकड़ लिया गया।)
-  **Incorrect:** *The fugitive idea is amazing.* (Wrong context — "fugitive" here doesn't mean "creative.") (भगोड़ा विचार अच्छा है। (अर्थ बिगड़ जाता है।))

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Remember "fugitive" from "fugitive gases" — escaping into the air. Fugitive = someone or something escaping. If you can imagine something running away or being fleeting (like time), think "fugitive." Helps in remembering both the person and temporary meaning.

- **Example + Low-Level Grammar Structure:**

- *The fugitive was hiding in an abandoned warehouse.* (भगोड़ा एक परित्यक्त गोदाम में छिपा हुआ था।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - **The** → definite article (specific fugitive)
 - **fugitive** → noun (subject)
 - **was hiding** → past continuous tense (action in progress in the past)
 - **in an abandoned warehouse** → prepositional phrase (place)

- **Common Collocations:**

- fugitive slave, fugitive from justice, fugitive moments, fugitive emissions

- **My Statement:**

- **(NOUN)**
 - The fugitive was none other than the prisoner who had escaped after being arrested a week ago.

- We are chasing a serious fugitive and want your help and cooperation.
- He was a known fugitive in the case, and I spotted him in the nearby village today.

- **(ADJECTIVE)**

- The fugitive nature of time can only be managed through careful utilization.
- Her fugitive excitement lasted until her exam results were announced.
- The fugitive period of recharge ended before she could finish it completely.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

2. Meritorious (योग्य) (Adjective) (meh-ruh-TOHR-ee-uhs) (Formal / Positive)

- **Meaning (English):** Deserving praise, reward, or recognition due to virtue, achievement, or effort.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** प्रशंसा, पुरस्कार, या मान्यता के योग्य।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *meritorius* → **meritum** ("deserved" or "earned") → Old French *méritoire* → Middle English *meritorious* → Modern English.
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** commendable, praiseworthy, admirable
 - **Antonyms:** blameworthy, unworthy, dishonorable
- **Connotation:** Strongly positive; carries a sense of honor and worthiness.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A teacher awarding a medal to a student who won a science competition after months of research.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In academic circles, meritorious research is often rewarded with grants and recognition, ensuring that innovation continues to flourish. For example, a scientist who develops an effective, low-cost water purification system for rural communities demonstrates both technical skill and social responsibility. Such contributions have tangible benefits for

society, and rewarding them sets a precedent for excellence. Meritorious actions are not limited to science or academia—they extend to any domain where dedication, integrity, and results align. In corporate environments, meritorious employees may receive promotions or bonuses, fostering motivation and setting a high benchmark for peers.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *Her meritorious service earned her the national award.* (उसकी योग्य सेवा ने उसे राष्ट्रीय पुरस्कार दिलाया।)
-  *He is meritorious in wearing expensive clothes.* (मंहगे कपड़े पहनने के लिए योग्य नहीं कहा जाता।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Think of "**merit**" inside the word—it signals worthiness. If something has "merit," it is meritorious. This works across contexts—academic, professional, or moral. Remember: not every achievement is meritorious; it must be earned through skill, dedication, or virtue.

- **Example + Detailed Low-Level Grammatical Structure Explanation:**

- The committee recognized her meritorious contribution to education.
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - **The committee** → subject (noun phrase)
 - **recognized** → verb (V2, past simple)
 - **her meritorious contribution** → object (noun phrase with adjective modifier "meritorious")
 - **to education** → prepositional phrase indicating field of contribution

- **Common Collocations:**

- meritorious service, meritorious conduct, meritorious achievement

- **My Statement:**

- He was awarded for his meritorious service in the army.
- He received praise from his teacher for his meritorious conduct in the classroom.
- It was a meritorious achievement for him after many years.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

3. Schadenfreude (दूसरों के दुख पर खुशी) (Noun) (SHAH-den-froy-duh) (Neutral to Negative, depending on tone)

- **Meaning (English):** Pleasure derived from another person's misfortune.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी और की विपत्ति से आनंद लेना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - German *Schaden* ("harm, damage") + *Freude* ("joy") → **adopted into English in the mid-19th century.**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** gloating, relish (in others' misfortune)
 - **Antonyms:** empathy, compassion, sympathy
- **Connotation:** Usually negative; can be humorous if light-hearted.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Two competitors in a race—one trips, and the other smirks with satisfaction.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In social psychology, schadenfreude is a well-documented emotion, often linked to competition and rivalry. It surfaces when individuals experience relief or pleasure at the setbacks of others, especially if they view them as rivals or undeserving of success. For example, an employee might feel schadenfreude if a boastful colleague is reprimanded.

While natural in small doses, unchecked schadenfreude can harm relationships and reduce cooperation. Media coverage of celebrity scandals often thrives on schadenfreude, as audiences relish the downfall of those perceived to have an unfair advantage. Recognizing this tendency helps in cultivating empathy and balanced judgment.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *His schadenfreude was evident when his rival failed the exam.* (जब उसका प्रतिद्वंद्वी परीक्षा में असफल हुआ, तो उसकी खुशी साफ दिख रही थी।)
-  *He felt schadenfreude after winning the lottery.* (लॉटरी जीतने से यह भावना नहीं आती।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Break it as **"Schaden" (damage) + "Freude" (joy)**. Imagine smiling when your rival's plan fails. This is schadenfreude. While a complex foreign word, the mental image of "joy in damage" makes it easy to remember.

- **Example + Detailed Low-Level Grammatical Structure Explanation:**

- The scandal sparked a wave of schadenfreude among his critics.
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - **The scandal** → subject (noun phrase)
 - **sparked** → verb (V2, past simple)
 - **a wave of schadenfreude** → object (noun phrase with prepositional phrase "of schadenfreude")
 - **among his critics** → prepositional phrase showing who experienced it

- **Common Collocations:**

- pure schadenfreude, indulge in schadenfreude, wave of schadenfreude

- **My Statement:**

- It was pure schadenfreude to watch him fail again and again.
- The group of boys indulged in schadenfreude over their biggest competitor.
- They experienced a wave of schadenfreude caused by the results of a test.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

4. Factoid (छोटी सी जानकारी / गलत तथ्य) (Noun) (FAK-toid) (Neutral)

- **Meaning (English):** A brief or trivial piece of information; sometimes a false statement accepted as fact.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** छोटी या महत्वहीन जानकारी; कभी-कभी एक गलत तथ्य जो सच मान लिया जाता है।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Coined by Norman Mailer (1973) from *fact* + *-oid* ("like"), initially meaning "a false fact"; later evolved to also mean "trivial fact."
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** tidbit, snippet, triviality
 - **Antonyms:** truth, verified fact, substantial information
- **Connotation:** Neutral, depends on accuracy of the factoid.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A TV host sharing "Did you know?" trivia before a commercial break.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Factoids populate social media feeds, offering bite-sized information that is easy to consume but not always accurate. While some factoids are harmless trivia—such as "a group of flamingos is called a flamboyance"—others can spread misinformation if unchecked. In journalism, factoids often serve to engage audiences without

overwhelming them with detail. However, responsible reporting demands that such tidbits be verified before dissemination. In marketing, factoids are used to hook attention quickly, often in the form of statistics or curious historical notes. The challenge lies in distinguishing genuine insights from oversimplifications or myths.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *The magazine article was filled with amusing factoids about wildlife.* (पत्रिका का लेख वन्यजीवन के बारे में रोचक तथ्यों से भरा हुआ था।)
-  *The professor presented factoids as the main evidence for his theory.* (गंभीर सिद्धांत के लिए केवल छोटी या गलत जानकारी का प्रयोग उचित नहीं।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Think of **"fact" + "oid"** = "fact-like." If it's small and possibly dubious, it's a factoid. To remember the negative sense, think: "Looks like a fact, but isn't fully one."

- **Example + Detailed Low-Level Grammatical Structure Explanation:**

- He ended the lecture with a curious factoid about ancient Rome.
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - **He** → subject (pronoun)
 - **ended** → verb (V2, past simple)
 - **the lecture** → object (noun phrase)
 - **with a curious factoid** → prepositional phrase showing manner
 - **about ancient Rome** → prepositional phrase modifying "factoid"

- **Common Collocations:**

- interesting factoid, useless factoid, random factoid

- **My Statement:**

- He presented an interesting factoid about his place.
- It is such a useless factoid. Even if you hadn't told us, we wouldn't have said anything.
- She shared a random factoid about the match that was streamed yesterday.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

5. Superfluous (अनावश्यक) (Adjective) (soo-PER-floo-uhs) (Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** Unnecessary, especially when more than enough exists.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** आवश्यकता से अधिक या बेकार।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *superfluus* ("overflowing") → **super-** ("over") + **fluere** ("to flow") → Old French *superflue* → **Middle English** *superfluous*.
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** excessive, redundant, needless
 - **Antonyms:** essential, necessary, indispensable
- **Connotation:** Negative when referring to wastefulness; neutral in literary excess.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A report padded with dozens of irrelevant pages of data.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In business communication, clarity often demands the removal of superfluous details that distract from the core message. Reports cluttered with redundant statistics or excessive jargon risk confusing the audience rather than enlightening them. Similarly, in design, minimalism thrives on eliminating superfluous elements, allowing essential features to shine. Academic writing, too, benefits from pruning out unnecessary words or repetitive ideas. The concept applies beyond language—budgeting requires cutting

superfluous expenses, and project management calls for identifying redundant tasks. In all contexts, recognizing what is superfluous helps maintain efficiency and focus.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  *Delete any superfluous paragraphs to make the essay concise.* (निबंध को संक्षिप्त बनाने के लिए अनावश्यक अनुच्छेद हटाएँ।)
-  *We need superfluous resources for the emergency.* (आपात स्थिति में अनावश्यक संसाधनों की जरूरत नहीं होती।)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Picture an overflowing glass—everything spilling out is superfluous. The "super" means "over," and "fluous" comes from "flow." If it's flowing over what's needed, it's unnecessary.

- **Example + Detailed Low-Level Grammatical Structure Explanation:**

- The meeting dragged on because of superfluous discussions.
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - **The meeting** → subject (noun phrase)
 - **dragged on** → verb phrase (phrasal verb, past simple)
 - **because of superfluous discussions** → prepositional phrase indicating cause

- **Common Collocations:**

- superfluous detail, superfluous remark, superfluous expenditure

- **My Statement:**

- We cannot do anything with the superfluous details of the project.
- We need to trim out superfluous expenditure so that we can allocate it to areas which truly deserve it.
- He made an unnecessarily superfluous remark about his brother

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]